

☀ **Welcome to the Black Belt Journey!**

Dear Students and Families,

Congratulations on reaching this exciting and challenging milestone in your martial arts training! Earning a black belt at Noble's Martial Arts is about more than just technique—it's a demonstration of your perseverance, discipline, and commitment to personal growth.

The black belt isn't given—it's earned. It represents years of dedication, countless hours of practice, and the courage to face both physical and mental challenges head-on. As you move through this journey, you'll be asked to push your limits, overcome obstacles, and strive to be your best not only as a martial artist but as a person. This is about who you are becoming in the process—not just the belt you'll wear at the end.

Black Belt Tests are offered twice each year—once in **February** and once in **August**. If a student becomes eligible in between testing cycles, they will participate in the **next upcoming test**. This ensures every candidate has the proper time to train, develop, and reflect. It also allows those who do not pass the first time to have a clear timeline for growth and a meaningful second attempt.

This 4-Month Training Workbook will guide you step-by-step through everything you need to know and do in order to confidently prepare for and succeed in the Black Belt Test. It includes:

- A breakdown of the Black Belt Test scoring system
- Detailed monthly training plans
- Weekly and daily fitness goals
- A progress tracker
- Encouragement and strategies for success!

You'll also find helpful reminders, motivational check-ins, and space to record your progress so you can reflect on how far you've come. This journey is as much about heart and mindset as it is about strength and technique.

You are not alone on this journey. Your instructor (ME!), classmates, and family are all here to support you every step of the way. Lean on them when needed and cheer for each other often. We are a team.

Let's get started!

The Black Belt Test: Scoring Breakdown (100 Points Total)

1. Fitness Test (25 Points Total)

The fitness portion of the Black Belt Test is designed to challenge your endurance, strength, and mental toughness. Each exercise will be scored based on performance within clearly defined expectations.

Push-Ups

You will complete **2 sets of 50 push-ups**:

- **Set 1: 50 Unbroken Push-Ups**
“Unbroken” means without stopping to rest in any way. Your body must remain in motion or in proper push-up position—no dropping to your knees, raising your hips, or pausing on the ground. The goal is to complete all 50 in one continuous effort.
- **Set 2: 50 Push-Ups in Under 90 Seconds**
After a short rest, you will attempt a second set of 50 push-ups. This time, pacing and brief pauses are allowed, but you must complete all 50 within **90 seconds**. The **maximum allowable time** is **150 seconds**, but to earn Tier 1, the full 50 must be done in **under 90 seconds**.

Scoring Tiers:

- **Tier 1: 5 points**
 - Set 1: 50 unbroken push-ups
 - Set 2: 50 push-ups completed in under 90 seconds
- **Tier 2: 3 points**
 - Set 1: 40–49 unbroken push-ups
 - Set 2: 50 push-ups completed in 90–120 seconds
- **Tier 3: 1 point**
 - Set 1: 30–39 unbroken push-ups
 - Set 2: 50 push-ups completed in 121–150 seconds
- **0 points**
 - Set 1: Fewer than 30 unbroken push-ups
 - Set 2: Did not complete all 50 push-ups

Wall Sit

This test measures leg endurance and mental grit.

- You must slide your back against a wall until your **thighs are parallel to the ground**, as if you were sitting in an invisible chair. Your knees should be directly above your ankles.
- Hands must remain off your thighs.
- You may shift your weight slightly to adjust, but **standing up, sliding out of position, or placing hands on thighs ends the attempt**.

Scoring Tiers:

- Tier 1: 5:00 minutes or more – 5 points
 - Tier 2: 3:00–4:59 minutes – 3 points
 - Tier 3: 1:30–2:59 minutes – 1 point
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Plank

This tests your core strength and focus.

- You must hold a standard **elbow plank**: forearms flat, shoulders above elbows, body in a straight line from shoulders to heels.
- You may make **small adjustments** to shift your weight or reposition your arms, but **setting a knee down ends the clock**.
- Focus on stillness, tight core engagement, and controlled breathing.

Scoring Tiers:

- Tier 1: 5:00 minutes or more – 5 points
- Tier 2: 3:00–4:59 minutes – 3 points
- Tier 3: 1:30–2:59 minutes – 1 point

Mile Run

This is an individual time trial for distance.

- You must complete a full mile (four laps on a standard track or measured course).
- You are allowed to **walk during the mile**, but the **total time must fall within the scoring range**. Pacing and interval strategies are allowed, but the clock does not stop until you cross the finish line.

Scoring Tiers:

- Tier 1: 8:00 minutes or faster – 5 points
- Tier 2: 8:01–9:00 minutes – 3 points
- Tier 3: 9:01–10:00 minutes – 1 point

Bonus Effort Points (Up to 5 Points)

Instructors may award up to 5 bonus points based on:

- Outstanding effort
- Indomitable spirit
- Team encouragement
- Visible perseverance despite challenges

2. KNOWLEDGE OF CURRICULUM (25 Points Total)

This portion of the test demonstrates your ability to recall, perform, and apply a wide range of martial arts techniques. These movements reflect the depth of your training and your readiness to represent the black belt level.

Forms

- Blocking Set
- Stone Stance
- Force 212
- Chon Ji
- Tang Soo
- Isshin

 *Forms are weighted highest to reflect their importance in demonstrating technique, precision, and memory.*

Self-Defense

Karate Defenses:

- Gateway
- Double Blades
- War Clubs
- Opponent at Sides
- Grasping Talon
- Windmill Guard
- Double Fangs
- Returning Viper
- Scimitar
- Drums of Manchu
- Lone Kimono
- Crossing Talon
- Driving Elbows
- Circling Serpent
- Flashing Dagger
- Intellectual Departure

Krav Maga Defenses:

- 360 Defenses
 - Defense vs Straight Punch
 - Headlock Defense
 - Defense vs Hook Punch
 - Front Choke Defense
 - Back Choke Defense
 - Front Choke with Push
 - Back Choke with Push
 - Front Choke (1-Hand Pluck)
 - Side Choke
-

Kickboxing Sets

- 3 Count
 - 7 Count
 - 9 Count
 - Cobra Fight Set (Grappling & BJJ)
 - Lion Fight Set (Muay Thai)
 - Dragon Fight Set (Pressure Points)
 - Crane Fight Set (Weapon Defenses)
-

Kick Sets

- Front Kick Combo
 - Round Kick Combo
 - Sidekick Combo
 - Cobra Kick Set (Front Kicks)
 - Lion Kick Set (Sidekicks)
 - Dragon Kick Set (Outside Crescents)
 - Crane Kick Set (Inside Crescents)
-

Weapons

- Single Nunchaku
 - Double Nunchaku
 - Bo Staff
 - Single Escrima
 - Double Escrima
 - Kama
-



Noble's Martial Arts – Black Belt Curriculum Checklist



Instructions:

Check off each item below as you gain confidence in your ability to perform it with skill, accuracy, and control. Use this sheet to guide your practice and identify areas that need extra attention.



Forms

- | | | |
|---------------------------------------|------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| ☐ Blocking Set | ☐ Force 212 | ☐ Tang Soo |
| ☐ Stone Stance | ☐ Chon Ji | ☐ Isshin |



Self-Defense

Karate Defenses:

- | | | |
|---|--|---|
| ☐ Gateway | ☐ Double Fangs | ☐ Driving Elbows |
| ☐ Double Blades | ☐ Returning Viper | ☐ Circling Serpent |
| ☐ War Clubs | ☐ Scimitar | ☐ Flashing Dagger |
| ☐ Opponent at Sides | ☐ Drums of Manchu | |
| ☐ Grasping Talon | ☐ Lone Kimono | |
| ☐ Windmill Guard | ☐ Crossing Talon | |
| ☐ Intellectual Departure | | |

Krav Maga Defenses:

- | | | |
|--|--|---|
| ☐ 360 Defenses | ☐ Punch | ☐ Front Choke (1-Hand Pluck) |
| ☐ Defense vs Straight | ☐ Front Choke Defense | ☐ Side Choke |
| ☐ Punch | ☐ Back Choke Defense | |
| ☐ Headlock Defense | ☐ Front Choke with Push | |
| ☐ Defense vs Hook | ☐ Back Choke with Push | |



Kickboxing Sets

- | | | |
|----------------------------------|---|---|
| ☐ 3 Count | ☐ Cobra Fight Set | ☐ Dragon Fight Set |
| ☐ 7 Count | (Grappling & BJJ) | (Pressure Points) |
| ☐ 9 Count | ☐ Lion Fight Set (Muay Thai) | ☐ Crane Fight Set |
| | | (Weapon Defenses) |

Kick Sets

- | | | |
|---|---|--|
| ☐ Front Kick Combo | ☐ Cobra Kick Set (Front Kicks) | ☐ Dragon Kick Set (Outside Crescents) |
| ☐ Round Kick Combo | ☐ Lion Kick Set (Sidekicks) | ☐ Crane Kick Set (Inside Crescents) |
| ☐ Sidekick Combo | | |
-

Weapons

- | | | |
|--|---|---|
| ☐ Single Nunchaku | ☐ Bo Staff | ☐ Double Escrima |
| ☐ Double Nunchaku | ☐ Single Escrima | ☐ Kamas |

3. CREATIVE PORTION (20 Points Total)

Earning a black belt is not just a physical accomplishment—it's a deeply personal journey. That's why this section of the test is designed to encourage students to reflect on everything they've learned and express it in meaningful and creative ways. This section is worth 20 total points and is broken into two parts:

Essay: "What Black Belt Means to Me" – 10 Points

This 4-paragraph (or longer) essay is your opportunity to share the *story* of your martial arts journey. The writing should describe:

- How you began martial arts and what your journey has been like
- What challenges you've overcome to reach this point
- What earning a black belt means to you personally
- How you will use what you've learned to help others—at home, at school, and in your community

Scoring Criteria:

Your essay will be graded on:

- Clarity and structure (Does it make sense and follow a logical order?)
- Depth and honesty (Are you sharing from the heart?)
- Effort (Did you give it your best and take your time?)
- Personal meaning (Does it truly reflect *your* journey?)

✨ **Note:** Essay expectations will vary slightly depending on your age. Older students will be expected to go into more depth, use proper grammar and organization, and reflect more maturely on their growth. Younger students may use simpler language but should still express themselves with sincerity and effort.

Once you are within **6 months** of your black belt test, you may begin writing your essay. You are **encouraged** to show it to me along the way! I'm happy to give feedback to help you improve it and make sure it meets all requirements.

Why do we do this?

Because a black belt should be able to **articulate** what martial arts has taught them—physically, mentally, and emotionally. You've worked hard to get here. Your words are part of your proof that the lessons went beyond the mat.

Creative Form – 10 Points

As a black belt candidate, you've spent years practicing katas, combinations, and sparring sets created by others. Now it's your turn to create your own.

Your **Creative Form** must include:

- **40 or more moves**
- A clear structure with stances, strikes, kicks, blocks, and transitions
- A **written or typed version** of your form turned in before test day
- Demonstrated performance of the form during your test

This form should showcase what you've learned over your martial arts journey. Use a combination of techniques that challenge you and demonstrate power, control, balance, and creativity. You may even give your form a name if you'd like!

Scoring Criteria:

- Creativity: Is it original and does it show your personal style?
- Difficulty: Are you pushing your skills with challenging moves?
- Flow: Does it have smooth transitions and logical structure?
- Execution: How well do you perform it on the day of the test?

Why do we do this?

A black belt is a martial artist—not just a student. This means you can take what you've been taught and create something new. Your creative form shows your understanding of movement, timing, and technique. It also shows your ability to express yourself through martial arts.

Remember:

This creative portion is just as important as the physical one. It shows your **mindset**, your **maturity**, and your ability to think beyond memorization. A true black belt thinks deeply, speaks clearly, and moves with purpose. You're almost there—this part is your chance to share what that means to *you*.

How to Create Your Own Creative Form

Creating your own form—also known as a **kata**—is one of the most exciting parts of the black belt journey. It gives you the chance to take everything you’ve learned and design a martial arts sequence that’s all your own. This is where creativity meets discipline, and where your understanding of movement, timing, and martial mindset comes to life.

What is a Form/Kata?

A **form** is a pre-set sequence of martial arts techniques meant to simulate a fight or defense situation. When you perform a form, you’re imagining multiple opponents coming at you from different angles. You respond with blocks, strikes, kicks, and footwork—just like in a real sparring or self-defense scenario.

Your **creative form** is like telling a story with martial arts.

What Should My Form Include?

- ✓ **At least 40 moves**
 - ✓ A combination of blocks, strikes, kicks, and stances
 - ✓ Techniques you’ve learned from forms, sparring, weapons, and kickboxing sets
 - ✓ Moves that flow together smoothly
 - ✓ A written or typed version turned in before test day
 - ✓ (Optional) A cool name for your form!
-

Tips for Building Your Form

1. Think in Sections

Break your form into **3–5 parts**, like chapters in a story. Each section could be:

- A defense against an attacker from the front
- A counter to a grab from behind
- A block-and-strike combo against a side attack

2. Use Your Knowledge

Pull from the techniques you’ve already learned Forms, Self-Defense, Kickboxing Sets & Weapons Forms

3. Show Variety

Use any of the different blocks, kicks, punches, elbows, and stances (horse, front, bow, guard, etc.). Add a spin or jump if you feel confident!

4. Add Transitions

Make your form smooth. Imagine your feet are always ready—stepping, turning, sliding, or pivoting between moves.

5. Use Your Voice

Kiai (yell) during powerful strikes! Show confidence and intention.

Example Section Breakdown

Section 1: Low block, front punch, front kick, step into horse stance

Section 2: Outside block, round kick, spinning back fist

Section 3: Low block, sidekick, elbow strike, turn to face “attacker” behind

Section 4: High block, double punch, jump front kick

Section 5: Final combination and strong ending pose!

Pro Tip:

Practice your form with intensity. Visualize the attackers. Don’t just perform the moves—**feel them**. Each technique should have a purpose, each stance should have strength, and each strike should have intention.

You are creating your own martial arts story. Make it powerful. Make it yours.

4. SPARRING (30 points total)

Black belt sparring is not about winning every exchange—it's about showing who you are when things get tough. During the test, students will complete **12 rounds of sparring**:

- **Rounds 1–10:** Each round is **30 seconds**, one-on-one with a fresh partner each time.
- **Rounds 11–12:** The final two rounds are **2-on-1**, also 30 seconds each.

These short but intense rounds challenge not just your physical endurance, but your mental strength, composure, and indomitable spirit. The constant rotation of fresh opponents means that you will get tired—but your task is to keep going. To stay calm. To defend. To attack with control. And most importantly, to persevere.

Why This Matters

In martial arts, sparring is where many of the lessons you've learned come together in real time:

- **Endurance:** Can you push through fatigue and keep moving?
- **Control:** Can you stay composed when your heart is pounding?
- **Technique:** Are you using what you've learned instead of just reacting?
- **Spirit:** When you're outnumbered or outpaced, do you keep fighting?

The final **2-on-1 rounds** are especially important. They simulate a high-pressure situation where the odds are stacked against you. You're not expected to dominate—you're expected to show heart, strategy, and control. A black belt must show what it means to **never give up**, even when things feel overwhelming.

We are looking for your **effort, courage, and mindset**—not whether you win every exchange. Stay respectful, stay sharp, and give it your all.

Reminder: Sparring will be supervised closely. Safety and control are top priorities.

👊 4-Month Training Guide: Tier 1 Preparation Plan

Instructions: Train 3–4x per week. Use the tracker on the last pages to monitor your progress. The goal is to build endurance, strength, and confidence to reach Tier 1 in all categories.

PUSH-UPS

Goal: 50 unbroken + 50 in under 90 seconds

The push-up challenge is one of the most iconic and demanding parts of your black belt preparation. It's more than just an upper-body strength test—it's a test of discipline, grit, and mental toughness. Achieving Tier 1 in this category means mastering both muscular endurance and pacing under fatigue. To do 50 push-ups unbroken, you'll need precise form, breath control, and an unshakable mindset. Then, after only a short break, completing another 50 push-ups within 90 seconds pushes your body and mind to their limits.

During this 4-month program, you'll train not only to build your chest, shoulders, and triceps—but also to develop the resilience needed to fight through physical discomfort and stay focused under pressure. Each week, you'll see progress, and each push-up will bring you closer to the black belt mindset: stay strong, stay focused, and never give up. Each month of training builds on the last:

- **Month 1** focuses on developing strength and perfecting form. Practicing slow, controlled push-ups (tempo training) helps build stability and muscle control.
- **Month 2** increases total volume. Add 1–2 reps per week to each set, track your max reps, and improve endurance through frequent short sets.
- **Month 3** introduces time pressure. Time yourself completing 50 push-ups and slowly work toward the 90-second goal by cutting 5–10 seconds off each week.
- **Month 4** puts everything together—test simulations, recovery pacing, and mental focus under fatigue.

Month	Focus	Weekly Goals	Daily Ideas
Month 1	Build strength & proper form	3 sets of 10–15 push-ups, 3x/week	Push-up ladders, tempo push-ups, negatives
Month 2	Increase endurance & volume	Add 2 reps per set/week, test weekly	Max rep set, shoulder taps, plank-to-push-up
Month 3	Add speed & control	Timed 50 push-ups, reduce by 10–15s/week	Stopwatch drills, rest & repeat
Month 4	Simulate test	50 unbroken + 50 under 90s, 1x/week	Test simulation, breathing control

How to Get Better at Push-Ups

Improving push-ups takes consistent practice, attention to form, and a plan that builds both strength and endurance. Here's how to grow your push-up power over time:

1. Master Your Form

- Keep your body in a straight line from your head to your heels.
- Hands should be slightly wider than your shoulders.
- Elbows should bend back at about a 45-degree angle.
- Lower your chest until it's just above the ground, then push back up.
- Avoid sagging your hips or raising your backside.

 **Tip:** Have someone video you or watch you to help check your posture.

2. Start with What You Can Do

- If you can't do a full push-up yet, start with:
 - Wall push-ups
 - Incline push-ups (on a bench or sturdy chair)
 - Negative push-ups (lower slowly, reset to top)

Gradually work your way down to flat ground as your strength improves.

3. Train in Sets

- Do 3–4 sets, 3 times per week.
- Begin with smaller sets (e.g., 5–10 reps) and add 1–2 reps weekly.
- Use rest between sets (30–60 seconds) to build recovery strength.

4. Add Variations for Strength

- Tempo Push-Ups (lower for 3 seconds, rise for 1)
- Diamond Push-Ups (hands close together)
- Wide Push-Ups (hands farther apart)
- Shoulder Tap Push-Ups (tap each shoulder at top)

These help activate different muscles and improve endurance.

5. Track Your Progress

- Use the tracker pages in this workbook to record how many you do each week.
- Try a "max rep" test once per week to see your improvement.

6. Don't Forget to Rest!

Muscles grow during recovery. Take at least one day off between push-up training days to allow your arms and chest to rebuild stronger.

Mental Tip:

Push-ups can get tough, especially near the end of a long set. Focus on your breathing, stay calm, and take it one rep at a time. Visualize yourself finishing strong!

WALL SIT

Goal: Hold for 5 minutes

The wall sit tests your lower body strength, endurance, and your ability to stay calm and mentally focused under physical stress. Holding your body in a seated position without the support of a chair may seem simple, but it quickly challenges your quads, glutes, and core. To meet the Tier 1 goal, you must maintain this position for a full five minutes—with your back flat against the wall and your thighs level, parallel to the ground.

This portion of your training will not only strengthen your legs but sharpen your mental discipline. Just like in sparring or forms, sometimes the challenge isn't moving—but holding strong in one place when your muscles are shaking and your brain is telling you to quit. Developing this strength will help you stay grounded and focused in every area of your martial arts journey.

Here's how your training will build:

- **Month 1** introduces short, frequent wall sits to strengthen key leg muscles. Pair these with squats and lunges for added support.
- **Month 2** increases the time under tension. Gradually raise your hold times each week while incorporating single-leg balance work.
- **Month 3** uses pyramid training to simulate test fatigue: build up hold time in intervals (1 min, 1.5 min, 2 min, etc.).
- **Month 4** is about maintaining composure and mental stamina—focus on holding strong with consistent form and calm breathing for as long as possible.

Month	Focus	Weekly Goals	Daily Ideas
Month 1	Build leg strength	3x/week: 3 sets of 30s + squats	Wall sits while brushing teeth
Month 2	Add hold time	1-min sets increasing weekly	Lunges around house, 1-leg holds
Month 3	Pyramid holds	1, 1.5, 2 min holds; squats	Watch a short video during hold
Month 4	Full duration	Hold 3–5 min 1x/week	Music or story focus hold

How to Get Better at Wall Sits

Improving your wall sit takes consistency and grit. The key is building strength in your legs while training your mind to stay calm and focused during discomfort.

1. Perfect Your Position

- Back flat against the wall
- Thighs parallel to the ground (like sitting in an invisible chair)
- Knees directly above ankles
- Feet shoulder-width apart
- Hands off your legs

 *Tip:* Set a timer and focus on your breathing to stay calm.

2. Start with Short Intervals

- Begin with 30-second holds, 3 sets per session
- Increase each set by 10–15 seconds per week
- Rest 1 minute between each set

3. Use Pyramid Holds

- Try building up and down: 1 min – 1.5 min – 2 min – 1.5 min – 1 min
- Helps simulate fatigue and improve stamina

4. Strengthen with Support Exercises

- Squats, lunges, and glute bridges help build wall sit strength
- Do 2–3 sets of these exercises after your wall sit training

5. Challenge Yourself Creatively

- Hold your wall sit while brushing your teeth or watching a short video
- Try a “don’t move until the music ends” game

Mental Tip:

When your legs start to shake, it’s your chance to practice mental toughness. Focus on the next 10 seconds, not the whole set. Stay still. Stay strong. Push through.

PLANK

Goal: Hold for 5 minutes

The plank is one of the best core-strengthening exercises in martial arts—and one of the hardest to maintain for long durations. Your goal is to keep your body straight, strong, and still for five full minutes. It's not just about your abs—it's about your shoulders, glutes, back, and your ability to stay mentally focused.

Small shifts are allowed, but setting a knee down resets your progress. Success in this challenge means developing body awareness and control over your breathing and posture. The better your core, the better your balance, technique, and power. Training for the plank will help every other part of your martial arts performance.

The path to five minutes looks like this:

- **Month 1** establishes your core baseline. Work short holds (30 seconds) often, and alternate between front and side planks.
- **Month 2** layers on difficulty. Add dynamic movements like shoulder taps and hollow body holds to activate deep core muscles.
- **Month 3** builds endurance. Push to 2–3 minute plank sessions with short rest breaks and gradually reduce those rests.
- **Month 4** simulates the full challenge—focus on pacing your breath, checking your alignment, and holding strong all the way to five minutes.

Month	Focus	Weekly Goals	Daily Ideas
Month 1	Strengthen core	3x/week: 3x30s front/side planks	Stillness, body awareness
Month 2	Add circuits	1+ min planks, hollow holds	Reach/tap games, superman hold
Month 3	Endurance	2–3 min sets, increasing	Plank contests with family
Month 4	Simulate test	5-min plank 1x/week	Mirror check for posture

How to Get Better at Planks

Planks improve your core strength, posture, and focus. Reaching a 5-minute hold takes time, so start small and build up steadily.

1. Check Your Form

- Elbows directly under shoulders
- Forearms flat on the ground
- Back straight, no sagging or arching
- Hips in line with shoulders
- Feet together or slightly apart

 *Tip:* Record yourself or use a mirror to check posture.

2. Use Plank Circuits

- Front Plank – Side Plank (Left) – Side Plank (Right)
- Start with 30 seconds each, then increase

3. Add Plank Variations

- Shoulder taps, plank reaches, and hollow holds target different muscles
- Switch it up 1–2 days per week to challenge yourself

4. Build Endurance Slowly

- Add 10–15 seconds to your hold every week
- Rest for a minute, then try again for a second set

5. Make It a Game

- Play calming music and try not to move until the song ends
- Compete with family members for longest hold

Mental Tip:

Focus on your breath and posture—not the clock. Think “strong and still” like a board. You are unshakable.

MILE RUN

Goal: 8-minute mile

The mile run is a full-body test of cardiovascular endurance and pacing strategy. To meet the Tier 1 goal, you must complete the full mile in 8 minutes or less. You are allowed to walk during the mile—but the total time still counts. That means even if you choose to take short walk breaks, you'll need to keep moving consistently to beat the clock.

This part of your preparation is just as much about mindset as it is about speed. It teaches you how to push through fatigue, regulate your breathing, and maintain a pace even when you're tired. Whether you're sprinting to finish strong or simply refusing to stop, your performance in this test will reflect your heart, your focus, and your warrior spirit.

Each month adds structure and purpose to your training:

- **Month 1** builds pacing awareness. Use run-walk intervals and track your time over a ½ mile. Focus on smooth, even effort.
- **Month 2** increases distance and intensity. Introduce ¾-mile jogs and short sprints to build speed.
- **Month 3** combines pacing and bursts. Try ¼-mile repeats and alternate between steady jogging and quick surges.
- **Month 4** is for dress rehearsals. Run the full mile weekly, track progress, and experiment with pacing strategies that help you finish strong.

Month	Focus	Weekly Goals	Daily Ideas
Month 1	Learn pace	Run/walk intervals, 1/2 mile jogs	Time neighborhood jogs
Month 2	Build cardio	3/4 mile jogs, 30s sprints	5-min jog after class
Month 3	Add speed	1-mile run, 1/4-mile bursts	Sprint-to-jog intervals
Month 4	Test pacing	Run full mile weekly	Log test times weekly

How to Get Better at the Mile Run

Running a fast mile is all about pacing, stamina, and mindset. You don't need to sprint the whole thing—but you do need to keep moving with purpose. Here's how to improve week by week:

1. Track Your Starting Time

- Time yourself on a full mile to get a starting point
- Write your results in your tracker each week

2. Use Run-Walk Intervals

- Run 1 minute, walk 1 minute, repeat
- Slowly increase the amount of time you run and reduce walking

3. Run Shorter Distances Faster

- Try ¼-mile or ½-mile runs at a strong pace
- Rest, then repeat 2–3 times

4. Do Speed Workouts

- Sprint 30 seconds, then walk 1 minute (repeat 5–8 rounds)
- This builds leg speed and heart strength

5. Run With a Purpose

- Pick a course and try to beat your time each week
- Focus on posture, breathing, and pacing

 **Tip:** It's okay to walk, but remember the clock keeps running—so keep your steps short and brisk.

Mental Tip:

The run can be tough. But it's also where warriors are made. Focus on passing the next tree, the next light pole, the next corner. One step at a time, just like your black belt journey.

Black Belt Mindset & Leadership

A Black Belt isn't just someone who kicks high or performs kata well—it's someone who **leads by example** and lives the values we teach at Noble's Martial Arts every single day. Black Belt candidates are expected to:

- Demonstrate **respect and humility** in every class.
- Encourage and support younger or lower-ranking students.
- Show **discipline** in training and at home.
- Model **positive behavior** in and out of the dojo.

Ask yourself regularly:

- ☒ Am I respectful in every class?
- ☒ Do I help those who struggle?
- ☒ Do I show perseverance when it gets tough?
- ☒ Do I represent NMA's values outside the dojo?

The Black Belt is the beginning of leadership. Act like the belt you're earning.

Mental Toughness Toolkit

The Black Belt test will push you physically—but also mentally. Success comes from preparing your **mind** as much as your body. Here are your tools:

☒ Positive Self-Talk

- "I can do this."
- "One more rep. One more step."
- "Strong body, stronger mind."

☒ Breathing Techniques

- Inhale for 4 seconds, hold 4, exhale for 4. Repeat to stay calm.

☒ Visualization

- Picture yourself doing each section of the test with confidence.
- Picture the final bow, wearing your black belt proudly.

☒ Reset & Refocus Plan

- If something doesn't go perfectly, breathe, reset, and keep going.

Black Belts don't quit. They **adapt**. They **overcome**. They **grow**.

Essay Planning Guide: “What Black Belt Means to Me”

All students must write an essay titled “**What Black Belt Means to Me**” at least 4 paragraphs long. Age, writing ability, and effort will be taken into account.

Use this structure to help:

- **Paragraph 1:** How your martial arts journey began. Why did you start?
- **Paragraph 2:** What challenges have you faced? What have you learned?
- **Paragraph 3:** What does Black Belt represent to you?
- **Paragraph 4:** How will you use your training to help others or grow personally?

 You may begin working on your essay **up to 6 months** before your Black Belt Test. You're welcome to share it with your instructor for feedback!

A Black Belt should be able to clearly **express** what this journey has meant—mentally, emotionally, and physically. That's why this essay is required.

Test Day: What to Expect

Preparation Tips:

- Get a full night of rest before the test.
- Eat a nutritious meal 1–2 hours before. No energy drinks or heavy foods.
- Bring water, a sweat towel, and all required gear.

What to Bring:

- Full uniform
- Sparring gear and weapons
- Printed or written Creative Form (40+ moves)
- Completed essay (if not already submitted)

Arrival Time:

- Arrive at least 15 minutes early.
- Use this time to stretch, breathe, and focus.

Mindset Going In:

- Trust your training—you've prepared for this.
- Focus on **effort**, **attitude**, and **endurance**.
- Encourage others, and remember—we're in this together.

 **This is your time to shine.** You've worked hard for this. Go show what you're made of!



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- **Set 2 (Under 90 seconds):** _____ seconds ☒

♦ Wall Sit

- **Time Held (in proper form):** _____ seconds ☒
(Thighs level, back flat, no hands on legs)

♦ Plank

- **Time Held (no knees down):** _____ seconds ☒
(Straight body line, elbows under shoulders)

♦ Mile Run

- **Total Time:** _____ minutes ☒
(Walking allowed, but clock runs continuously)



Notes & Reflection:

- What felt strong this week?

- What do you want to improve next week?

- Did you practice with a partner or family member? ☐ Yes ☐ No



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